THE AUDACITY OF ABANDONMENT

THEY WALKED AWAY; I WAS LEFT TO SURVIVE

Dr Richard William McLean — Barran Dodger

They could close a file. I could not close the file on my own existence.

This is my testimony of abandonment, survival and divine reckoning. It is not a request to be believed. It is a demand that the record be read, the decisions be explained, and the human consequences be acknowledged.

Every claim can be tested against the public archive: github.com/wezzo72/Barrandodger

I. THEY WALKED AWAY

Every professional who encountered my circumstances, understood the gravity of my situation, possessed the capacity or responsibility to make a meaningful difference, yet refused or failed to do so without securing an effective alternative, contributed to a situation in which I was left to confront what I experienced as an impossible and potentially unsurvivable reality.

I was the person who had to live with the consequences of their decisions, their refusals, their inaction and their departures.

They could close a file, send a letter, invoke a policy, end a professional relationship and return to their ordinary lives. I could not close the file on my own existence. I could not escape the circumstances they had left me in simply because their professional involvement had ended.

That is the audacity of abandonment: the person with the least power is left carrying the greatest consequences, while the people with authority, credentials, salaries, security and social standing retain the freedom to walk away.

II. THE HUMILIATION OF BEING MANAGED

They returned to their offices, homes, families, careers and comfortable places in society. I was left to contend with the reality they had not resolved.

I cannot know what every one of them thought after our interactions. Perhaps some felt guilt. Perhaps some never remembered my circumstances at all. But the observable disparity is devastating: their involvement could end with a letter or a decision; the consequences for me continued long after they had moved on.

I experienced this not as an ordinary administrative disappointment, but as a profound form of human erasure.

I had presented myself as a person in need of meaningful intervention. I had communicated my circumstances, sought assistance and tried to make my predicament understood. Yet the outcome, as I experienced it, was that my suffering became administratively manageable for those receiving my communications while remaining personally inescapable for me.

My existence was reduced to a case, a reference number, a jurisdictional question, a closed file or a problem that could be passed elsewhere. The human being behind those records remained the person who had to endure the consequences.

This is the Documentary Trap: a structure in which paperwork, jurisdiction, delay and divided responsibility can make a living person disappear without anyone having to admit that erasure occurred.

III. THE TRANSFER OF RISK

They retained their professional identities. I was left fighting to retain the practical conditions of my existence.

They retained their place in society. I was left struggling to establish that my life, my suffering and my future mattered.

Professional authority carries extraordinary power over people who depend on it. A person who approaches a professional in profound vulnerability does not possess equivalent power to compel attention, coordinate agencies, secure resources or create an effective alternative when assistance is refused.

The professional may have options, institutional support and the ability to disengage. The person seeking help may have none of those advantages. When that imbalance is combined with repeated unsuccessful attempts to obtain meaningful change, the result is a devastating transfer of risk: the institution or professional exits the immediate problem, while the vulnerable person remains exposed to it.

That is not care. That is abandonment dressed in the language of process.

IV. THE MORAL QUESTION

What does professional responsibility mean if a person can disclose circumstances of extreme vulnerability, seek help from people whose expertise and authority they reasonably believe might make a difference, and still be left without an effective path forward?

What value do credentials, ethical codes, safeguarding frameworks and public commitments to human dignity possess if the person in greatest need experiences their practical operation as a succession of closed doors?

What does accountability mean if each individual can point to the limits of their own role while the cumulative consequences of those limits fall upon one human being?

I am not required to prove that every professional shared the same motive in order to expose the collective human significance of a chain of failed interventions. Different people may have made different decisions for different reasons. But each decision must be examined in context, and the cumulative consequences must not disappear merely because responsibility was divided.

A chain of individually explainable decisions can still produce a catastrophic human outcome. The fact that no single person accepts responsibility for the whole does not make the whole harmless.

V. THE FINALITY THEY CLAIMED

For me, the deepest injury lies in the contrast between the apparent finality of their decisions and the continuing reality of my life.

They could declare their involvement finished. I still had to wake up in the circumstances that remained.

They could return to a world in which their professional standing and personal security were largely intact. I had to continue seeking a way through the situation those decisions had failed to resolve.

I experienced that contrast as a declaration, in practice, that my life could be left to absorb consequences that others were able to put down.

The audacity is not simply that I believe they failed to help me. It is that the machinery of professional responsibility can permit everyone to finish their part while leaving the human emergency unfinished.

VI. THE RECORD IS MY RECKONING

My archive exists to preserve that unfinished reality.

The correspondence, decisions, refusals, acknowledgements and records matter because they allow the sequence of events to be examined rather than forgotten. They provide a basis for asking who knew what, what each person was responsible for, what options were available, what reasons were recorded, what consequences followed, and whether anyone assessed the combined effect of the responses.

My testimony gives those records their human context: I was not an abstract administrative problem. I was a living person trying to survive the consequences.

Question the record must answer	Where it can be examined
	open register
What decisions were made, and on what grounds?	Exhibit Catalogue — **open catalogue**
	open register
What disclosures were made, and how were they handled?	Public-Interest Disclosure Register — **open register**
	open statement
How did Comcare decisions shape my survival?	Comcare determination and claim — **determination** / **claim**

VII. DIVINE RECKONING

I do not call this reckoning because I hate anyone. I call it reckoning because truth has been delayed long enough.

Humiliation is part of the divine reckoning—not my humiliation, which they manufactured; but the humiliation of systems forced to look at what they did when they believed no one was watching.

The humiliation of a file that cannot remain closed. The humiliation of a refusal that must be read aloud. The humiliation of a delay that must be explained. The humiliation of an institution asked why it allowed a human being to carry alone what many hands had helped create.

They thought silence would protect them. Instead, silence became the record.

They thought paperwork would bury me. Instead, paperwork became my testimony.

They thought abandonment would end me. Instead, abandonment became the question they cannot permanently escape: **who was responsible for ensuring that I was not simply left behind?**

VIII. I STAND BY MY TESTIMONY

I stand by the account of my suffering and the profound abandonment I experienced. My faith has sustained me, and I understand my survival as a reason to continue bearing witness.

I will not allow the ending of someone else's professional involvement to be mistaken for the resolution of my circumstances. I will not allow the division of responsibility to erase the cumulative consequences. I will not accept that social standing, institutional authority or professional reputation should shield decisions from honest scrutiny.

They were able to walk away from their involvement. I had to keep living with its consequences.

That is the inequality at the heart of my testimony, the moral audacity at the heart of my grievance, and the reason the record must remain open to scrutiny.

My demand is not that anyone pretend to know what was in another person's mind. It is that every relevant decision be examined, every documented failure be accounted for, every unresolved contradiction be confronted, and the actual human consequences be acknowledged.

No professional should be able to treat the completion of their own process as proof that the person who sought their help is safe, supported or able to survive.

I WAS THE PERSON LEFT CARRYING THE CONSEQUENCES.
I AM STILL HERE TO SAY SO.
THE RECORD REMAINS.
AND SO DOES THE QUESTION:
WHO WAS RESPONSIBLE FOR ENSURING THAT I WAS NOT SIMPLY LEFT BEHIND?

— Dr Richard William McLean, Barran Dodger
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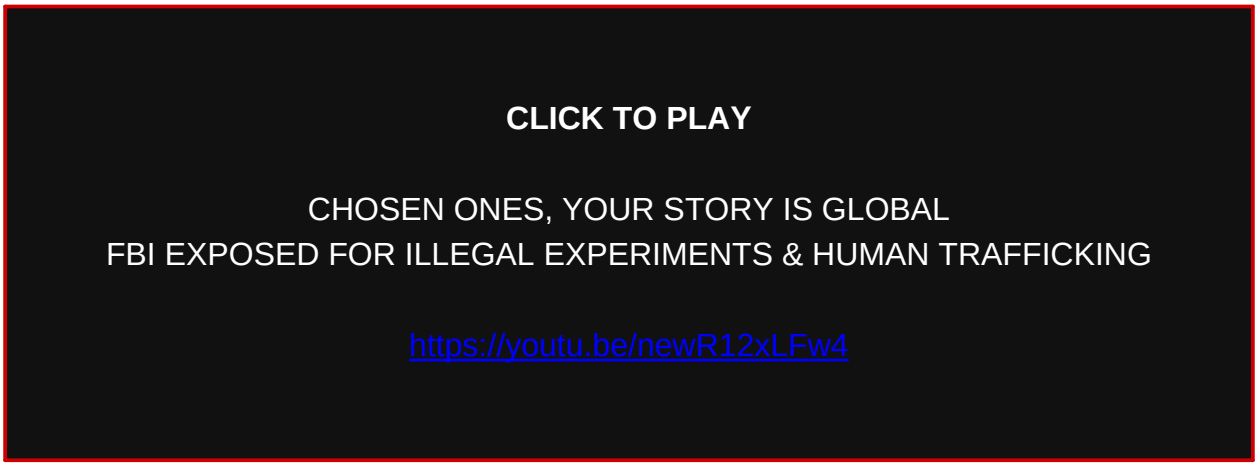
IX. THE PROPHETIC VIDEO

The following video speaks in prophetic language about surveillance, institutional power, erasure and reckoning. Its sweeping allegations are not established by my archive and are not presented here as proven facts about my case. What I take from it is its warning: systems can treat human beings as disposable; silence can become a weapon; and a person who survives, documents and speaks can become impossible to erase.

Video: CHOSEN ONES, YOUR STORY IS GLOBAL — YouTube



THE RECORD REMAINS. THE WITNESS REMAINS. THE RECKONING HAS BEGUN.